

AutoLISP / Visual LISP Reference Notes

Codex

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1 Purpose

This file inventories the official references consulted during the information-gathering phase for AutoLISP / Visual LISP specification work.

It is intentionally source-oriented rather than normative.

2 Autodesk References

2.1 Current Core Documentation

- AutoLISP and Visual LISP
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-49AAEA0E-C422-48C4-87F0-52FCA491BF2C.htm>
 - High-level language history and positioning; states AutoLISP introduction in AutoCAD Release 2.1.
- AutoLISP Developer's Guide
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-265AADB3-FB89-4D34-AA9D-6ADF70FF7D4B.htm>
 - Table of contents for language concepts, workflows, and DCL.
- AutoLISP Functions By Name and Feature Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2015/PLK/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-4CEE5072-8817-4920-8A2D-7060F5E16547.htm>
 - Useful for coarse partitioning of the language into feature families.
- Related Developer References
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-7884190F-4603-4E9F-8FB3-0D683BD7C4C9.htm>
 - Pointers to DXF, ObjectARX, ActiveX, and Managed .NET references.

2.2 Language-Concept Pages

- About Variables
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/HUN/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-CC89231D-E10F-47D0-A1FD-A989D24C7105.htm>
- About Symbols and Variables
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/FRA/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-1855E7B0-2474-49E6-9EE3-8BC541FC1CC8.htm>
- About Defining a Function

- <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP/files/GUID-9EDF48C2-1678-4DC3-BFD6-9D1DEAC525F0.htm>
- About Point Lists
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/HUN/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-BFED8707-AB01-49BC-B0A9-D872794311DF.htm>
- About Dotted Pairs
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2022/PLK/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-877B87BA-6FA2-4894-9F94-184E7DF25B7D.htm>
- About Error Handling
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP/files/GUID-027AD2E0-5AC5-48DA-B451-112B7EECE40F.htm>
- Commenting Program Code
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP-Tutorials/files/GUID-D28C82C0-A490-4A89-B577-1E77FBA0F02A.htm>

2.3 Reference Pages Used for Semantic Details

- Function-handling Functions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-6804DF2D-E5C4-466A-9869-3CDD7A031FAA.htm>
- Query and Command Functions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2016/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-F9ABE09D-9A71-4C00-8E5D-5BA70C3797B5.htm>
- Application-handling Functions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2016/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-E2B683FE-43FB-4F5D-A9AE-809772FE8D3B.htm>
- User Input Functions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2016/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-49DBE7DD-D1D2-4B3A-9718-E3F4E2FD5E81.htm>
- V Functions Reference

- <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/FRA/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-26FF2BE2-B5BF-4DD1-A617-36727E51F516.htm>
- VLX Namespace Functions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/CHT/AutoCAD-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-5784FC6F-82DD-4459-879B-6EC3BD5E88D1.htm>
- AutoLISP Extensions Reference
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/KOR/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-07C3599E-EC87-4EC0-8F0B-8DE4BD150A64.htm>
- About Supported Programming Interfaces
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-Customization/files/GUID-E6429154-36DF-4D84-8ABC-9FCA15B66158.htm>

2.4 Individual Function / Variable Pages Used for Version and Platform Notes

- LISPSYS
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-Core/files/GUID-1853092D-6E6D-4A06-8956-AD2C3DF203A3.htm>
- ascii
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/KOR/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-03E1B586-72CB-4AB6-A151-B581AE530318.htm>
- vl-string-search
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/PLK/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-4E7AE1DA-1ED5-4D96-A7D3-34241AA94AA6.htm>
- setvar
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/KOR/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-B1CE1BFB-2448-47F1-95EC-10E9509F01FA.htm>
- vl-vbaload
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/PLK/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-54FD698E-8D94-4E27-9DF1-3F7E9D451E05.htm>

- `vllx-import-type-library`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/CHS/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-1699B6A0-C4A6-4BC4-82DF-5040CFF3394A.htm>
- `cons`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/FRA/AutoCAD-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-33B418E7-DB3D-4CBE-954E-F070F0A7CB2B.htm>
- `cdr`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/FRA/AutoCAD-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-F9CD8FF3-022A-4323-BAE7-390174451537.htm>
- `entmake`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/PLK/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-D47983BA-1E5D-417D-85B8-6F3DE5F506BA.htm>
- `tblnext`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/PTB/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-1720D8DC-5559-4AC1-8A75-3C932834D77C.htm>
- `function`
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/KOR/AutoCAD-MAC-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-CF7E5870-561F-42DB-B134-CCD41EF93A25.htm>
- **push-error-using-stack**
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-LT-AutoLISP-Reference/files/GUID-C28420C9-2210-4EEC-AA73-2962999D1BC1.htm>

2.5 Release and Change History

- What's New or Changed with AutoLISP (2026 page; includes recent release history)
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2026/ENU/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-037BF4D4-755E-4A5C-8136-80E85CCEDF3E.htm>
- New and Changed AutoLISP Functions Reference (2015 page; contains 2009-2015 changes)

- <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2015/ESP/AutoCAD-AutoLISP/files/GUID-037BF4D4-755E-4A5C-8136-80E85CCEDF3E.htm>
- AutoLISP Improvements (AutoCAD 2021)
 - <https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2021/ENU/AutoCAD-WhatsNew/files/GUID-80F564DA-A5C4-4242-91DB-2331E231E2A6.htm>

2.6 Ancillary Autodesk Items

- AutoCAD OEM Support for AutoLISP/LISP
 - <https://blog.autodesk.io/autocad-oem-support-for-autolisplisp/>
- Opensource Announcement for AutoCAD AutoLISP Extension
 - <https://blog.autodesk.io/opensource-announcement-for-autocad-autolisp-extension/>

3 Bricsys References

3.1 General and Versioned Reference Access

- Area for Developers
 - <https://help.bricsys.com/developers>
- Current-version LISP overview
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/CurVer/DevRef/source/LISP.htm
- Offline Help for current and previous BricsCAD versions
 - <https://help.bricsys.com/en-us/document/knowledge-base/where-can-i-find-offline-help-for-current-and-previous-bricscad-versions>

3.2 Developer Reference Overview by Version

- V9 overview
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V9/DevRef/source/IDR_DEV551.htm
- V10 overview

- https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V10/DevRef/source/DevRef_Overview.htm
- V14 overview
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V14/DevRef/source/DevRef_Overview.htm
- V19 overview
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V19/DevRef/source/DevRef_Overview.htm
- V24 overview
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V24/DevRef/source/DevRef_Overview.htm

3.3 BricsCAD Compatibility and Extension Pages

- LISP Compatibility (V9)
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V9/DevRef/source/IDR_LISP_B100.htm
- What's New and What's More in BricsCAD Lisp
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/WhatsNew.htm
- BricsCAD-specific LISP Functions
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/BricsCADLISPFunctions.htm
- VLE LISP Function Library
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V15/DevRef/source/VLELISPFunctionLibrary.htm
- LISP Benchmark
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/LISPBenchmark.htm
- Lisp Optimiser: How it works

- https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/Howitworks.htm
- Optimised Code Patterns
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/OptimisedCodePatterns.htm
- read + write text files
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/readwritetextfiles.htm
- Generic Properties Functions
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/GenericPropertiesFunctions.htm
- VLX NameSpace Support
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/VLXNameSpaceSupport.htm
- DEScoder LISP encryption
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/DESCoderLISPencryption.htm
- vlisp-compile
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/vlisp-compile.htm

3.4 BricsCAD Vertical / Extended LISP APIs

- BIM LISP API
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/BricsCADBIMLISPAPI.htm
- GeoCoordinateSystem LISP API
 - https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/BricsCADGeoCoordinateSystemLISPA.htm
- Mechanical LISP API

- https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V25/DevRef/source/BricsCADMechanicalLISPAPI.htm

- SheetSetManager COM/LISP API

- https://developer.bricsys.com/bricscad/help/en_US/V23/DevRef/source/BricsCADSheetSetManagerCOMLISPAPI.htm

3.5 Current Help Center Material Relevant to Practical Compatibility

- Migrating custom files

- <https://help.bricsys.com/en-us/document/bricscad/getting-started-with-bricscad/migrating-custom-files>

- BLADE command

- English result was not directly surfaced in search, but current localized command-reference pages confirm BLADE as the BricsCAD Lisp Advanced Development Environment.

- Release notes entry point

- <https://help.bricsys.com/en-us/document/knowledge-base/where-can-i-find-the-release-notes>

4 Main Conclusions from the Source Corpus

- There is no single vendor-neutral AutoLISP / Visual LISP standard document comparable to the Common Lisp HyperSpec.
- Autodesk’s documentation corpus is the closest thing to a normative reference for the core language.
- BricsCAD explicitly targets AutoLISP compatibility, but also extends the language/runtime significantly.
- Version changes matter, especially for:
 - Unicode behavior,
 - Visual LISP / ActiveX availability,
 - AutoCAD LT support,

- BricsCAD VLE and optimizer features,
 - BricsCAD packaging, namespace, and vertical APIs.
- Any implementation that aims at compatibility needs dialect and version switches, not a single undifferentiated behavior model.